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General Comment

While AI is here to stay, that does not give Big Tech the carte blanche to use other's work and present as their own. Google uses AI overviews to censor publishers it doesn't like by removing them from the results page. And through AI overviews, it takes their work and presents it as its own with the express purpose of keeping users on Google and not on creator's own website, therefore keeping ad revenue and incentivizing sponsored posts as the only way people can have their own work be seen after Google takes it.

If we don't have copyright protection, then what is the point for any small business to create anything new? For too long, AI has been used to copy every creator's work on the internet without their permission- Generative AI doesn't "know" anything so the only results it can possibly come up with are by looking for what others have created already. That is a feature, not a bug of the system.

Big Tech whole model of profitability for AI is based on theft and eventually, it will drive out small publishers who form the backbone of the internet. Then we will have the same crap regurgitated in a multiple ways but without any real knowledge at its base. Is that what everyone wants?

Copyright law has been seen as important since the 1700s and intellectual property rights were seen as important as physical property. Would you be okay if AI came by and took your car and gave it to someone else because it was asked to create a black pickup truck with 4 doors? That is essentially what is happening here.

We have a chance to steer the development of AI away from blatant theft and into a truly useful tool for Americans to use. Similar to how Napster was shut down but Spotify improved on it to become the better (and legal) version. But it was a Swedish company who did it because they wanted to prove that you could have a better option than stealing. Why can't an American company find a better way than stealing? Maybe its our laws and that is where you come in.